October 2026 Feature Guide

Smart Club Platform · what's new, who it's for, and how each feature works

Everything in this guide is built, reviewed and tested, and goes live with the next deployment. A few items are already live on the development environment only; the status table on the last page shows exactly where each feature stands. Features are grouped by who uses them.

1. For club chairs and representatives (club portal)

1.1 Moving a fixture: postponement by agreement

Until now a fixture could only be moved by phoning the union office. Clubs can now agree a new date between themselves, inside the portal, and the fixture updates itself.

- The chair of either club opens the fixture and requests a new date, with a short reason (rain, ground unavailable, a clash with a school event).
- The other club sees the request in its portal inbox and can **accept**, **decline**, or **counter** with a different date. The clubs take turns until one side accepts.
- The moment a proposal is accepted, the fixture moves to the agreed date automatically. Nobody at the union office has to retype anything.
- The union admin can step in at any point with a final ruling (date, time and venue), which ends the negotiation. Both clubs see the ruling and acknowledge it.
- Only one open request per fixture is allowed, and the whole conversation is recorded: who proposed what, and when.

> The usual fixture safeguards still apply: a proposed date that would create a clash with another match is flagged before anyone agrees to it.

1.2 Registering your own players (chair registration)

Chairs no longer depend on each player finding the public registration link. A club can now register its players directly from the portal, three ways:

- **Single form**: the same registration form players use, filled in by the chair.
- **Quick-add grid**: a spreadsheet-style grid in the browser for capturing several players in one sitting (name, ID number, and so on).
- **Spreadsheet upload**: download the provided template, fill it in offline, upload it back. Rows with problems are named individually so you can fix just those.

Every route runs the same checks as the public form: duplicates are caught, a player coming from another club opens a transfer (clearance) as usual, and required documents still apply.

1.3 Automatic fixture reminders

Clubs now receive reminders ahead of match day, so nobody arrives unaware of a venue or time change. The union chooses how many days before the match reminders go out, and each chosen lead day sends its own reminder. Reminders go by email now; WhatsApp follows as soon as Meta approves the message template.

1.4 Fixtures shown as matchups

Fixture lists in the portal now read the way people talk about a match: **Home side vs Away side**, with your own club's name in bold so your fixtures are easy to spot. Fixture emails name your side the same way.

2. For union administrators (admin console)

2.1 Transfer windows

Unions only accept inter-club transfers during set periods. The platform now enforces that for you.

- Each union can have named windows, for example “Mid-season window, 1–31 December”. Inside a window, transfers work exactly as before.
- Outside a window, a club rep who tries to start a transfer gets a clear refusal that says when the next window opens.
- A player registering through the public link who would need a transfer is **not** turned away with an error. Their registration is recorded and automatically rejected, so the union office can see who tried to move, and the player stays registered at their current club. Nothing disappears silently.
- First-time registrations (players not registered anywhere) are never blocked by a window.
- A union with no windows configured keeps today's behaviour: transfers any time.

Windows are set up by the platform operators on the union's instruction, so changing them is a deliberate step, not a console toggle an admin can trip over.

2.2 Transfer notifications and reminders

Transfers used to go stale because nobody knew one was waiting. Now:

- The moment a transfer opens, the **destination club's chair** and the **union admins** are notified by WhatsApp and email (where contact details exist).
- Admins can send a **manual reminder** for any waiting transfer, straight from the console.
- The platform also sends **scheduled automatic reminders** for transfers that sit unanswered, counting only reminders that actually went out, so a failed send does not silence the next one.

2.3 Player erasure (POPIA)

When a player makes a verified request to be forgotten, an admin can now erase them across the entire union in one guarded action: roster entries, uploaded ID documents, transfers, certificates and match-report mentions are all cleaned up together. The action is permanent and asks for explicit confirmation before it runs.

2.4 Simpler season setup

Setting up a season is now one guided path: a quick-start that builds the whole season from a few answers, one setup per league, editing per season rather than one global settings page, and plain-language error messages when something does not add up.

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3. For platform operators (operator portal)

3.1 Client switcher

Operators work across many unions. A new **Switch client** menu jumps straight into any client's admin console or club portal with one click, no signing out and back in.

3.2 Sport verticals and the registration page

Each union is now set up for its sport. The public registration page follows suit: a schools-football union never shows cricket-only questions (batting style, bowling arm), and a registration can no longer save a cricket profile the player never picked. The page also waits for the union's settings to load before deciding

what to show, so there is no flash of the wrong form.

3.3 Transfer certificates with QR verification

Completed transfers can produce a formal certificate (two per-union templates). Each certificate carries a QR code backed by a cryptographic signature; scanning it opens a public verification page that confirms the certificate is genuine and unaltered. Certificates are view-only for now (no automatic sending).

4. Smaller changes and behind-the-scenes work

- **Fuel costs removed from travel views.** Rand amounts are gone from travel displays; distances in km remain.
- **Match-day sync digest.** After each sync with the medicoach match centre that includes report activity, the union admin gets a WhatsApp digest of what came through (the message template is already approved by Meta).
- **Season imports.** The EMCU 2026-27 season (620 fixtures across 11 series) is imported and awaiting release to clubs; the Lions/CGL onboarding (43 clubs, 1,525 fixtures) is imported on schedule.
- **School office bearers.** School unions capture a Director of Academics and school-appropriate committee roles instead of club-style ones.

5. Where each feature stands

“Next deployment” means the feature is finished and merged, and goes live on both environments with the upcoming release.

Feature	Status today
Fixture postponement negotiation	Next deployment
Chair-led player registration	Next deployment
Automatic fixture reminders	Next deployment (email first; WhatsApp awaits Meta approval)
Transfer windows + auto-reject	Next deployment
Transfer notifications & reminders	Next deployment
Player erasure (POPIA)	Next deployment
Operator client switcher	Next deployment
Registration page per sport (hardened)	Next deployment
Match-day sync digest	Next deployment
Fuel cost removal	Next deployment
Fixtures as matchups	Live on dev; production with next deployment
Simpler season setup	Live on dev; production with next deployment
Sport verticals (Smart School)	Live on dev; production with next deployment
Transfer certificates + QR verify	Live on dev; production with next deployment
EMCU season (620 fixtures)	Imported; awaiting release to clubs
Lions/CGL onboarding	Imported (43 clubs, 1,525 fixtures)